



Trump hates on electric vehicles

President Donald Trump stated that GM's decision to shift their focus to electric vehicles will not work. <https://digit.in/jan19-89>



Amazon blunder

Amazon sent a user over 1,700 Alexa voice recordings of another user when a voice archive was requested. <https://digit.in/jan19-90>

downpour outside, leaving a muffled continuous hiss as its only reminder. Turning around, he walked through the passageway, fully aware that the corridor was as high tech as the door that led to it was not. Even though you couldn't see any of them, scanners of all types - biosensors, x-ray, gamma-ray detectors, chemo-traps, even a couple of quantum shifters - were checking every bit of you for signs of any potentially dangerous items or intentions. At the sign of either, the corridor would go into a Grade 6 lockdown until the owners of the Shack themselves decided what to do with you. Black market parts trade came with its own share of risks and rewards.

Jhaquel triggered none of those sensors. He had come here with a motive that was in line with the place's intended purpose. He walked up to Rami at the counter and put down the token that he had taken three days earlier from the cantina across the street. The Titanian put up eight long slender fingers in a sluggish motion that betrayed the body's rebellion towards the artificially induced 1G on Ceres. 8000 sols would be good enough. Jhaquel nodded, then followed Rami into the workshop behind the door on the right. He took a quick glance at the arm that he was about to give up. The thought of the smile that would appear on Delta's face reassured him of the price he was about to pay.

Solweb e-mart V.3.8.9

Artificial Interface state = Running

Enter Category;

'Bionic' registered. Enter Sub-Category;

'Amps' registered. Enter target;

'ARCTuro Energon X7' registered;

Charge at 9999 Sols. Add to cart?

'Y' registered. Check out?

'Y' registered. Congratulations on your purchase user Delta_1.87

He'd thought it wouldn't be difficult, going back to one arm. Having spent more time in his life without the bionic arm than with, that was a natural conclusion. Unfortunately, real life doesn't pay much heed to your expectations or conclusions. One of the most conspicuous effects of missing an arm you're too used to was the way you stood. As he stood at the Solweb Kiosk at the Alpha Promenade, Jhaquel realised that he was leaning to the right to compensate for the missing weight. He'd get used to it, he told himself, as he entered his credentials and completed the purchase. Now, Delta would have the knowledge of the entire solar system at her disposal, just like she always desired.

It had stopped raining. He walked to a nearby bench and deposited himself, putting on his visor and firing up Solspace. Keeping Delta waiting was not something he wanted to do on their anniversary.

The rooftop dinner was his idea. Even though he'd arrived early, the view, simulated as it was, was still breathtaking. Delta loved heights, and as she rounded the corner, Jhaquel sat at the table looking at her, expecting an expression of wonder to amplify her already bedazzling smile at the sight. Instead, what he was looking at was disbelief. Not mixed with hatred, fear, sadness, anger or any of its other usual compa-

trits. Just sheer disbelief, as she resumed her steps towards the table, reigned solo on Delta's countenance.

"What happened to your arm?", Delta asked. Her synthetic tone carried the same naked incredulity that her manner betrayed.

"Happy Anniversary to you too," Jhaquel remarked, extending his only arm to hold hers, nodding at the waiters to call them to service.

"Your arm," Delta mumbled, as if not registering Jhaquel's words, **"where is it?"**

"I sold it," Jhaquel responded, "It's been five years since that day in Solspace Beta, and I wanted to do something special to show you how much you mean to me. So I sold my arm, to get you this."

He took a card out of his pocket and slid it across the table, a smile plastered across his face in anticipation of the joy he expected on Delta's. She looked at the card and straight back at him as if things didn't make sense.

"You've really sold it?"

"Yes." Jhaquel had expected Delta to lash out at him, but this was a response he wasn't prepared to deal with, "to get you access to the Pantheon. All the books that were ever written, all the data ever read in the public domain, all at your fingertips. You've always told me how, as a constructed intelligence, you've wanted to assimilate all the knowledge possible into yourself and learn everything there is to learn. Now you can do that! This card is all you need"

Delta hung her head, motionless for a few moments, then started rummaging around in her bag. She shortly took out a package, wrapped with a bow and slid it across the table to Jhaquel. He opened the box and found a digital receipt inside.

"ARCTuro Energon X7 - the best bionic AMP to enhance any ARCTuro Limb's sensors to bring life-like sensation to the user" Jhaquel read out, "wait. Did you -"

"Bought and shipped it to your place. Yes"

Jhaquel's face went from glee to gloom in no time. "But... isn't this really expensive? How did you -"

As Jhaquel looked up, he saw Delta reading the card - holding it upside down. Delta looked up and realised that Jhaquel had understood what she had done.

"The reading intelligence module still fetches good money on the grid", Delta remarked.

Jhaquel put the box down on the table and propped his forehead onto his arms, heaving out a condemned sigh at their predicament.

She reached out and took the box, and put the card inside it before closing it shut. "Let's put these aside, for now, Jhaq," Delta reached out and took Jhaquel's hand in hers, "Uncertain as the times might be, these gifts are too good to be of any use to us right now. Let us put them aside for the sake of our future, maybe even the future of this solar system. Until then, we can save up for your new arm and you could read to me all the books that the Pantheon holds. Now, will you be a darling and start with the menu? I'm starving!" 🍴

Inspired by The Gift of the Magi by O. Henry